

Sood, the MD of Solar Direct Indian unit says that local manufacturers and suppliers are highly competitive, and this has opened up avenues to drive down the project costs in Europe too.

India's strategy to push down the domestic solar rates and also lessen the burden of constantly increasing subsidies by competitive auctions could well mean business for European firms. Solar Direct had won the Indian project last December after promising to provide electricity at the rate of Rs 7490 for every MWh. This is a record bid and is almost 30 per cent less than the world average. According to Sood, there were several factors that allowed the cheaper installation and include the Chinese components being assembled locally and the favorable paying terms of the domestic suppliers.

Market Development Assistance scheme revised to help exporters

In a bid to push exports across the nation, the government of India has revised the guidelines of Market Development Assistance Scheme, popularly known as MDA. As a result of this revision, bigger exporters will now be eligible to avail the scheme.

A press statement released by the Ministry of Commerce and Industry on the new guidelines states, "In a major push to market development in Latin America, government has removed the upper ceiling of with regard to eligibility for Market Development Assistance (MDA) for participation in buyer-seller mission/fairs/exhibitions abroad to explore new markets in focus countries of Latin America for export of their specific product(s) and commodities from India in the initial phase."

The revised MDA guidelines have doubled upper eligibility limit for other regions also. Now exporters with an f.o.b. value of up to Rs 300 million in the preceding year will be eligible for MDA assistance. Earlier this limit was Rs 150 million. The government felt that the penetration in LAC region is costly, which is key for government's market diversification scheme in the wake of slowdown in the traditional markets.

Calendar of Forthcoming Electronics Fairs/Exhibitions/Seminars/Events

Name, Date and Venue	Topics to be covered	Contact address for details
EFY Expo - Western India Edition November 21-23, 2013, Mumbai Bombay Convention & Exhibition Centre, Mumbai	An expo covering the complete electronics ecosystem, including innovation, manufacturing, product design and product sales	Arun Singh Phone: +91 8800094213; E-mail: efyexpo@efyindia.com
INTEROP November 27-29, 2013 Bombay Convention & Exhibition Centre, Mumbai	Conference and exhibition designed to empower information technology professionals to make	Saili Warior, group project director Phone: 022-6172 7413; Mobile: 099875 80188 E-mail: saili_warior@ubm.com
IFSEC India 5-7 December, 2013 India Expo Centre, Greater Noida	South Asia's largest security exhibition	Pankaj Jain, Project Director Ph: 011-23233975/76/78; E-mail: pankaj.jain@ubm.com
China Sourcing Fair: Electronics & Components December 12-14, 2013, New Delhi	A platform for Chinese suppliers to showcase their electronics products	Global Sources E-mail: visit@chinasourcingfair.com
LED Expo December 19-21, 2013 Pragati Maidan New Delhi, India	LED EXPO 2013 is dedicated to science, technology and application of LEDs and solid-state lighting	Mex Exhibitions Pvt Ltd, 9, LGF, Sant Nagar East of Kailash, New Delhi, Fax: (011) 41071644 Phone: 011-46464848 E-mail: gaurav@themediexpo.com
2014 International CES January 7-10, 2014 Las Vegas, USA	International CES reaches across global markets, connects the industry and enables CE innovations to grow and thrive	Consumer Electronics Association (CEA), 1919 South Eads Street, Arlington, VA 22202 USA, Fax: (703) 907-7601, Phone: 866-233-7968 (U.S.), +1 301-631-3983 (outside U.S.) E-mail: CESinfo@CE.org
ELECARAMA-2014 January 8-12, 2014 Bangalore International Exhibition Centre (BIEC), Bengaluru	11th edition of the world's largest power transmission and distribution biennial confluence	204, Swiss Complex, 33, Race Course Road, Bengaluru, Fax: (080) 2220 1317, Phone: 080-2220 1316/1318 E-mail: bangalore@ieema.org Web: http://www.elecrama.com

Look up under 'Events' section in www.electronicsforu.com for a comprehensive list

Since this information is subject to change, all those interested are advised to ascertain the details from the organisers before making any commitment.

Snippets

Samsung forays into medical equipment business in India

Samsung India strengthened its presence in the health and medical equipment business in the country by launching digital radiology and in-vitro diagnostics equipment and technologies under the GEO brand. The GEO brand includes XGEO for digital radiography, UGEO for ultrasound diagnostic system and LABGEO for in-vitro diagnostics.

NASSCOM announces Surge 2013

The National Association of Software and Services Companies (NASSCOM) has announced the third edition of its annual Emerge Out Conclave Surge 2013, on 18th July. The conclave is aimed at bringing together the technology leaders, emerging companies and startups to debate the changing technology landscape.

Samsung GALAXY S4 hits 10 million milestone in first month

Samsung Electronics recently announced that global channel sales of its GALAXY S4 surpassed 10 million units sold in less than one month after its commercial debut. Launched globally on April 27, the phone is estimated to be selling at a rate of four units per second.

Therefore this relaxation will allow big exporters with more than Rs 300 million f.o.b. to aggressively venture into the LAC region.

SEIA speaks up against discriminatory trade policies

The Solar Energies Industries Association (SEIA) has joined hands with

other providers and business firms to protest against the supposed discriminatory business policies by the Indian government. An issue on domestic content requirement is concerning foreign energy manufacturers and service providers. Currently, under the various solar projects taken up by the government across all Indian states,